

G2 Differentiating functions

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Time: **464 minutes**

Marks: **383 marks**

Comments:

EXAM PAPERS PRACTICE

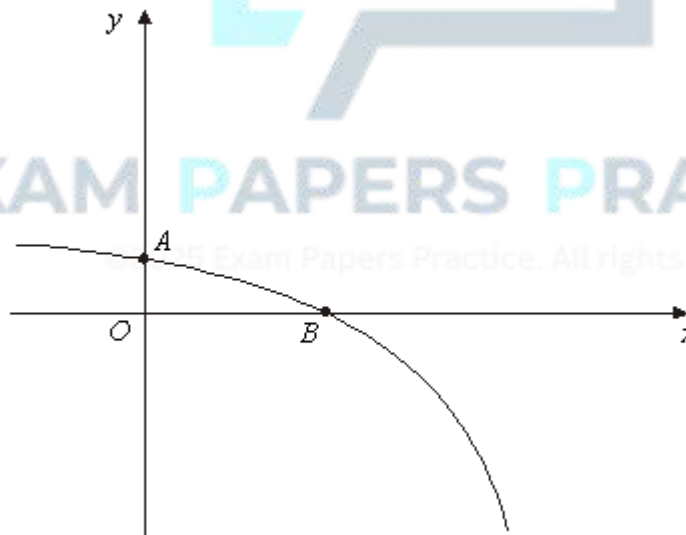
©2025 Exam Papers Practice. All rights reserved.

Q1.

- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ when:
- (i) $y = (4x^2 + 3x + 2)^{10}$; (2)
- (ii) $y = x^2 \tan x$. (2)
- (b) (i) Find $\frac{dx}{dy}$ when $x = 2y^3 + \ln y$. (1)
- (ii) Hence find an equation of the tangent to the curve $x = 2y^3 + \ln y$ at the point (2,1). (3)
- (Total 8 marks)**

Q2.

The sketch shows the graph of $y = 4 - e^{2x}$. The curve crosses the y -axis at the point A and the x -axis at the point B .



- (a) (i) Find $\int (4 - e^{2x}) dx$. (2)
- (ii) Hence show that $\int_0^{\ln 2} (4 - e^{2x}) dx = 4 \ln 2 - \frac{3}{2}$. (2)

- (b) (i) Write down the y -coordinate of A . (1)
- (ii) Show that $x = \ln 2$ at B . (2)
- (c) Find the equation of the normal to the curve $y = 4 - e^{2x}$ at the point B . (4)
- (d) Find the area of the region enclosed by the curve $y = 4 - e^{2x}$, the normal to the curve at B and the y -axis. (3)
- (Total 14 marks)**

Q3.

- (a) (i) Solve the differential equation $\frac{dy}{dt} = y \sin t$ to obtain y in terms of t . (4)
- (ii) Given that $y = 50$ when $t = \pi$, show that $y = 50e^{-(1 + \cos t)}$. (3)
- (b) A wave machine at a leisure pool produces waves. The height of the water, y cm, above a fixed point at time t seconds is given by the differential equation
- $$\frac{dy}{dt} = y \sin t$$
- (i) Given that this height is 50 cm after π seconds, find, to the nearest centimetre, the height of the water after 6 seconds. (2)
- (ii) Find $\frac{d^2 y}{dt^2}$ and hence verify that the water reaches a maximum height after π seconds. (4)
- (Total 13 marks)**

Q4.

A model helicopter takes off from a point O at time $t = 0$ and moves vertically so that its height, y cm, above O after time t seconds is given by

$$y = \frac{1}{4}t^4 - 26t^2 + 96t, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 4$$

- (a) Find:

(i) $\frac{dy}{dt}$ (3)

(ii) $\frac{d^2y}{dt^2}$ (2)

(b) Verify that y has a stationary value when $t = 2$ and determine whether this stationary value is a maximum value or a minimum value. (4)

(c) Find the rate of change of y with respect to t when $t = 1$ (2)

(d) Determine whether the height of the helicopter above O is increasing or decreasing at the instant when $t = 3$. (2)

(Total 13 marks)

Q5.

A curve is defined for $x > 0$ by the equation

$$y = \left(1 + \frac{2}{x}\right)^2$$

The point P lies on the curve where $x = 2$.

(a) Find the y -coordinate of P . (1)

(b) Expand $\left(1 + \frac{2}{x}\right)^2$. (2)

(c) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ (3)

(d) Hence show that the gradient of the curve at P is -2 . (2)

(e) Find the equation of the normal to the curve at P , giving your answer in the form $x + by + c = 0$, where b and c are integers. (4)

(Total 12 marks)

Q6.

- (a) Differentiate $\ln x$ with respect to x .

(1)

- (b) Given that $y = (x + 1) \ln x$, find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

(2)

- (c) Find an equation of the normal to the curve $y = (x + 1) \ln x$ at the point where $x = 1$.

(4)

(Total 7 marks)

Q7.

A biologist is researching the growth of a certain species of hamster. She proposes that the length, x cm, of a hamster t days after its birth is given by

$$x = 15 - 12e^{-\frac{t}{14}}$$

- (a) Use this model to find:

- (i) the length of a hamster when it is born;

(1)

- (ii) the length of a hamster after 14 days, giving your answer to three significant figures.

(2)

- (b) (i) Show that the time for a hamster to grow to 10 cm in length is given by

$$t = 14 \ln \left(\frac{a}{b} \right),$$

where a and b are integers.

(3)

- (ii) Find this time to the nearest day.

(1)

- (c) (i) Show that

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = \frac{1}{14}(15 - x)$$

(3)

- (ii) Find the rate of growth of the hamster, in cm per day, when its length is 8 cm.

(1)

(Total 11 marks)

Q8.

The point $P(1, a)$, where $a > 0$, lies on the curve $y + 4x = 5x^2y^2$.

- (a) Show that $a = 1$. (2)
- (b) Find the gradient of the curve at P . (7)
- (c) Find an equation of the tangent to the curve at P . (1)
- (Total 10 marks)**

Q9.

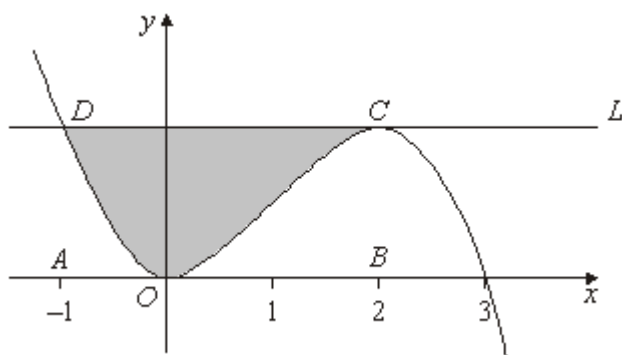
The volume, $V \text{ m}^3$, of water in a tank at time t seconds is given by

$$V = \frac{1}{3} t^6 - 2t^4 + 3t^2, \quad \text{for } t \geq 0$$

- (a) Find:
- (i) $\frac{dV}{dt}$; (3)
- (ii) $\frac{d^2V}{dt^2}$. (2)
- (b) Find the rate of change of the volume of water in the tank, in $\text{m}^3 \text{ s}^{-1}$, when $t = 2$. (2)
- (c) (i) Verify that V has a stationary value when $t = 1$. (2)
- (ii) Determine whether this is a maximum or minimum value. (2)
- (Total 11 marks)**

Q10.

The diagram shows the curve with equation $y = 3x^2 - x^3$ and the line L .



The points A and B have coordinates $(-1, 0)$ and $(2, 0)$ respectively. The curve touches the x -axis at the origin O and crosses the x -axis at the point $(3, 0)$. The line L cuts the curve at the point D where $x = -1$ and touches the curve at C where $x = 2$.

- (a) Find the area of the rectangle $ABCD$. (2)
- (b) (i) Find $\int (3x^2 - x^3) dx$. (3)
- (ii) Hence find the area of the shaded region bounded by the curve and the line L . (4)
- (c) For the curve above with equation $y = 3x^2 - x^3$:
- (i) find $\frac{dy}{dx}$; (2)
- (ii) hence find an equation of the tangent at the point on the curve where $x = 1$; (3)
- (iii) show that y is decreasing when $x^2 - 2x > 0$. (2)
- (d) Solve the inequality $x^2 - 2x > 0$. (2)
- (Total 18 marks)**

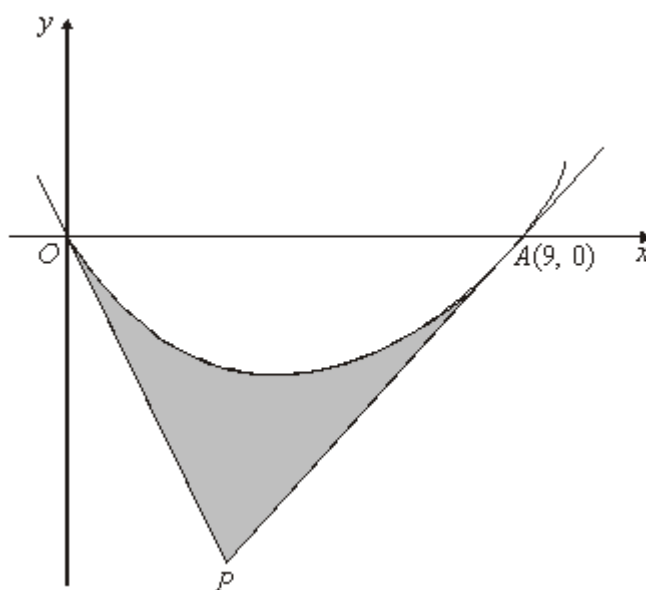
Q11.

Given that $y = 16x + x^{-1}$, find the two values of x for which $\frac{dy}{dx} = 0$.

(Total 5 marks)

Q12.

A curve, drawn from the origin O , crosses the x -axis at the point $A(9, 0)$. Tangents to the curve at O and A meet at the point P , as shown in the diagram.



The curve, defined for $x \geq 0$, has equation

$$y = x^{\frac{3}{2}} - 3x$$

- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (2)

- (b) (i) Find the value of $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at the point O and hence write down an equation of the tangent at O . (2)

- (ii) Show that the equation of the tangent at $A(9, 0)$ is $2y = 3x - 27$. (3)

- (iii) Hence find the coordinates of the point P where the two tangents meet. (3)

- (c) Find $\int \left(x^{\frac{3}{2}} - 3x \right) dx$. (3)

- (d) Calculate the area of the shaded region bounded by the curve and the tangents OP and AP . (5)

(Total 18 marks)

Q13.

- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ when $y = \tan 3x$. (2)

- (b) Given that $y = \frac{3x+1}{2x+1}$, show that $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{1}{(2x+1)^2}$. (3)

(Total 5 marks)

Q14.

- (a) (i) Given that $f(x) = x^4 + 2x$, find $f'(x)$. (1)

- (ii) Hence, or otherwise, find $\int \frac{2x^3 + 1}{x^4 + 2x} dx$. (2)

- (b) (i) Use the substitution $u = 2x + 1$ to show that

$$\int x\sqrt{2x+1} dx = \frac{1}{4} \int \left(u^{\frac{3}{2}} - u^{\frac{1}{2}} \right) du$$

(3)

- (ii) Hence show that $\int_0^4 x\sqrt{2x+1} dx = 19.9$ correct to three significant figures. (4)

(Total 10 marks)

Q15.

A curve has equation $y = 7 - 2x^5$.

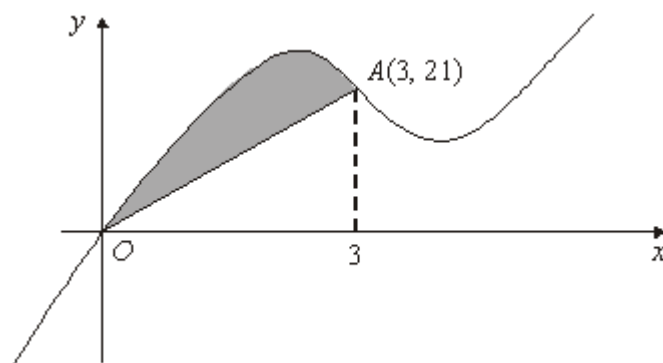
- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (2)

- (b) Find an equation for the tangent to the curve at the point where $x = 1$. (3)

- (c) Determine whether y is increasing or decreasing when $x = -2$. (2)
- (Total 7 marks)

Q16.

The curve with equation $y = x^3 - 10x^2 + 28x$ is sketched below.



The curve crosses the x -axis at the origin O and the point $A(3, 21)$ lies on the curve.

- (a) (i) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (3)

- (ii) Hence show that the curve has a stationary point when $x = 2$ and find the x -coordinate of the other stationary point. (4)

- (b) (i) Find $\int (x^3 - 10x^2 + 28x) dx$. (3)

- (ii) Hence show that $\int_0^3 (x^3 - 10x^2 + 28x) dx = 56\frac{1}{4}$. (2)

- (iii) Hence determine the area of the shaded region bounded by the curve and the line OA . (3)

(Total 15 marks)

Q17.

At the point (x, y) , where $x > 0$, the gradient of a curve is given by

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 3x^{\frac{1}{2}} + \frac{16}{x^2} - 7$$

- (a) (i) Verify that $\frac{dy}{dx} = 0$ when $x = 4$. (1)

- (ii) Write $\frac{16}{x^2}$ in the form $16x^k$, where k is an integer. (1)
- (iii) Find $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$. (3)
- (iv) Hence determine whether the point where $x = 4$ is a maximum or a minimum, giving a reason for your answer. (2)
- (b) The point $P(1, 8)$ lies on the curve.
- (i) Show that the gradient of the curve at the point P is 12. (1)
- (ii) Find an equation of the normal to the curve at P . (3)
- (c) (i) Find $\int (3x^{\frac{1}{2}} + \frac{16}{x^2} - 7) dx$ (3)
- (ii) Hence find the equation of the curve which passes through the point $P(1, 8)$. (3)
- (Total 17 marks)**

Q18.

- (a) A curve has equation $y = e^{2x} - 10e^x + 12x$.
- (i) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (2)
- (ii) Find $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$. (1)
- (b) The points P and Q are the stationary points of the curve.
- (i) Show that the x -coordinates of P and Q are given by the solutions of the equation
- $$e^{2x} - 5e^x + 6 = 0$$
- (1)

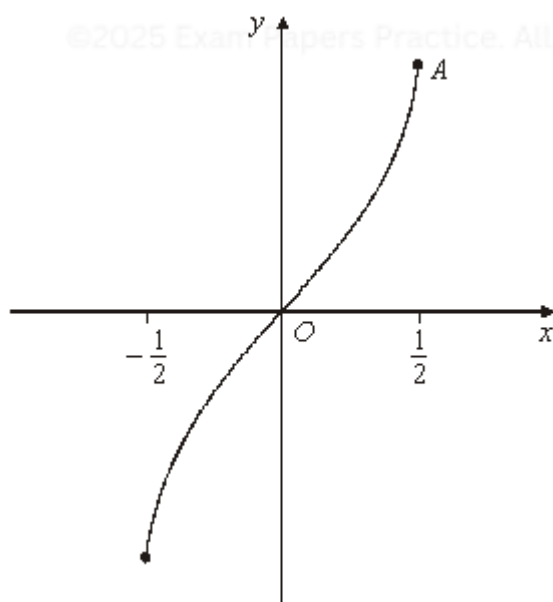
- (ii) By using the substitution $z = e^x$, or otherwise, show that the x -coordinates of P and Q are $\ln 2$ and $\ln 3$. (3)
- (iii) Find the y -coordinates of P and Q , giving each of your answers in the form $m + 12 \ln n$, where m and n are integers. (3)
- (iv) Using the answer to part (a)(ii), determine the nature of each stationary point. (3)
- (Total 13 marks)**

Q19.

- (a) Given that $y = x \ln x$, find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (2)
- (b) Hence, or otherwise, find $\int_1^{\ln} x \, dx$. (2)
- (c) Find the exact value of $\int_1^5 \frac{1}{x} \, dx$. (2)
- (Total 6 marks)**

Q20.

The diagram shows the curve with equation $y = \sin^{-1} 2x$, where $-\frac{1}{2} \leq x \leq \frac{1}{2}$.



(a) Find the y -coordinate of the point A , where $x = \frac{1}{2}$. (1)

(b) (i) Given that $y = \sin^{-1} 2x$, show that $x = \frac{1}{2} \sin y$. (1)

(ii) Given that $x = \frac{1}{2} \sin y$, find $\frac{dx}{dy}$ in terms of y . (1)

(c) Using the answers to part (b) and a suitable trigonometrical identity, show that

$$\frac{dx}{dy} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{1-4x^2}}$$

(4)
(Total 7 marks)

Q21.

A curve is defined by the equation

$$y^2 - xy + 3x^2 - 5 = 0$$

(a) Find the y -coordinates of the two points on the curve where $x = 1$. (3)

(b) (i) Show that $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{y-6x}{2y-x}$. (6)

(ii) Find the gradient of the curve at each of the points where $x = 1$. (2)

(iii) Show that, at the two stationary points on the curve, $33x^2 - 5 = 0$. (3)
(Total 14 marks)

Q22.

A curve has equation $y = x^5 - 6x^3 - 3x + 25$.

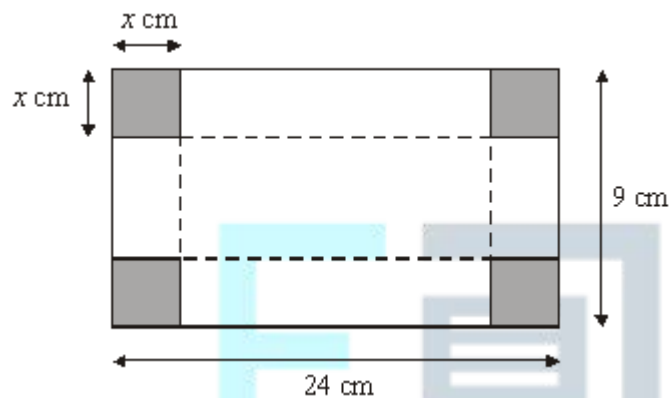
(a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$. (3)

(b) The point P on the curve has coordinates $(2, 3)$.

- (i) Show that the gradient of the curve at P is 5. (2)
- (ii) Hence find an equation of the normal to the curve at P , expressing your answer in the form $ax + by = c$, where a , b and c are integers. (3)
- (c) Determine whether y is increasing or decreasing when $x = 1$. (2)
- (Total 10 marks)

Q23.

The diagram below shows a rectangular sheet of metal 24 cm by 9 cm.



A square of side x cm is cut from each corner and the metal is then folded along the broken lines to make an open box with a rectangular base and height x cm.

- (a) Show that the volume, V cm³, of liquid the box can hold is given by $V = 4x^3 - 66x^2 + 216x$. (3)
- (b) (i) Find $\frac{dV}{dx}$. (3)
- (ii) Show that any stationary values of V must occur when $x^2 - 11x + 18 = 0$. (2)
- (iii) Solve the equation $x^2 - 11x + 18 = 0$. (2)
- (iv) Explain why there is only one value of x for which V is stationary. (1)

(c) (i) Find $\frac{d^2V}{dx^2}$.

(2)

(ii) Hence determine whether the stationary value is a maximum or minimum.

(2)

(Total 15 marks)

Q24.

A curve is defined for $x > 0$ by the equation $y = x + \frac{2}{x}$.

(a) (i) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

(3)

(ii) Hence show that the gradient of the curve at the point P where $x = 2$ is $\frac{1}{2}$.

(1)

(b) Find an equation of the normal to the curve at this point P .

(4)

(Total 8 marks)

Q25.

(a) (i) Using the binomial expansion, or otherwise, express $(2 + x)^3$ in the form $8 + ax + bx^2 + x^3$, where a and b are integers.

(3)

(ii) Write down the expansion of $(2 - x)^3$.

(2)

(b) Hence show that $(2 + x)^3 - (2 - x)^3 = 24x + 2x^3$.

(2)

(c) Hence show that the curve with equation

$$y = (2 + x)^3 - (2 - x)^3$$

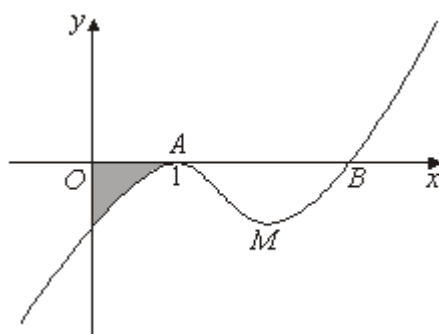
has no stationary points.

(3)

(Total 10 marks)

Q26.

The curve with equation $y = x^3 - 5x^2 + 7x - 3$ is sketched below.



The curve touches the x -axis at the point A $(1, 0)$ and cuts the x -axis at the point B .

- (a) (i) Use the factor theorem to show that $x - 3$ is a factor of

$$p(x) = x^3 - 5x^2 + 7x - 3$$

(2)

- (ii) Hence find the coordinates of B .

(1)

- (b) The point M , shown on the diagram, is a minimum point of the curve with equation $y = x^3 - 5x^2 + 7x - 3$.

- (i) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

(2)

- (ii) Hence determine the x -coordinate of M .

(3)

- (c) Find the value of $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$ when $x = 1$.

(2)

- (d) (i) Find $\int (x^3 - 5x^2 + 7x - 3) dx$.

(4)

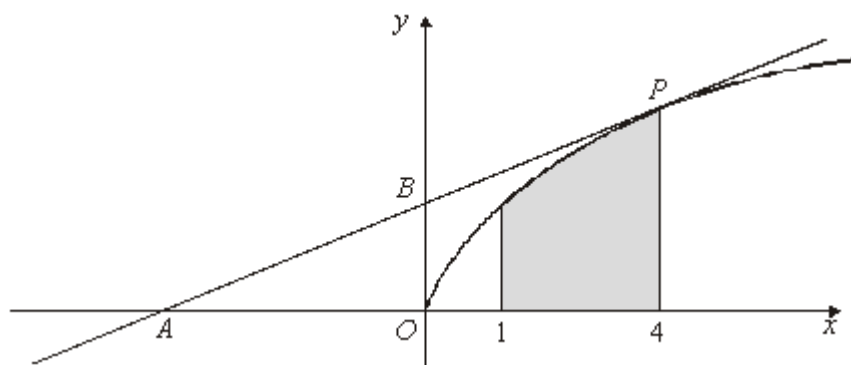
- (ii) Hence determine the area of the shaded region bounded by the curve and the coordinate axes.

(4)

(Total 18 marks)

Q27.

The diagram shows a curve C with equation $y = \sqrt{x}$. The point O is the origin $(0, 0)$.



The region bounded by the curve C , the x -axis and the vertical lines $x = 1$ and $x = 4$ is shown shaded in the diagram.

- (a) (i) Write $\sqrt{x}$ in the form x^p , where p is a constant. (1)
- (ii) Find $\int \sqrt{x} \, dx$. (2)
- (iii) Hence find the area of the shaded region. (3)
- (b) The point on C for which $x = 4$ is P . The tangent to C at the point P intersects the x -axis and the y -axis at the points A and B respectively.
- (i) Find an equation for the tangent to the curve C at the point P . (4)
- (ii) Find the area of the triangle AOB . (3)
- (c) Describe the single geometrical transformation by which the curve with equation $y = \sqrt{x-1}$ can be obtained from the curve C . (2)
- (d) Use the trapezium rule with four ordinates (three strips) to find an approximation for $\int_1^4 \sqrt{x-1} \, dx$, giving your answer to three significant figures. (4)
- (Total 19 marks)**

Q28.

A curve is defined, for $x > 0$, by the equation $y = f(x)$, where

$$f(x) = \frac{x^8 - 1}{x^3}$$

- (a) Express $\frac{x^8 - 1}{x^3}$ in the form $x^p - x^q$, where p and q are integers. (2)
- (b) (i) Hence differentiate $f(x)$ to find $f'(x)$. (2)
- (ii) Hence show that f is an increasing function. (2)
- (c) Find the gradient of the normal to the curve at the point $(1, 0)$. (3)
- (Total 9 marks)**

Q29.

- (a) Find $\int e^{4x} dx$. (1)
- (b) Use integration by parts to find $\int e^{4x}(2x + 1) dx$. (3)
- (c) By using the substitution $u = 1 + \ln x$, or otherwise, find $\int \frac{1 + \ln x}{x} dx$. (4)
- (Total 8 marks)**

Q30.

A particle moves in a straight line. At time t seconds, it has velocity v m s⁻¹, where

$$v = 6t^2 - 2e^{-4t} + 8$$

and $t \geq 0$.

- (a) (i) Find an expression for the acceleration of the particle at time t . (2)
- (ii) Find the acceleration of the particle when $t = 0.5$. (2)
- (b) The particle has mass 4 kg.
- Find the magnitude of the force acting on the particle when $t = 0.5$. (1)
- (c) When $t = 0$, the particle is at the origin.

Find an expression for the displacement of the particle from the origin at time t .

(4)

(Total 9 marks)

Q31.

A particle moves in a horizontal plane under the action of a single force, $\mathbf{F}$ newtons. The unit vectors $\mathbf{i}$ and $\mathbf{j}$ are directed east and north respectively. At time t seconds, the velocity of the particle, $\mathbf{v} \text{ m s}^{-1}$, is given by

$$\mathbf{v} = 4e^{-2t} \mathbf{i} + (6t - 3t^2)\mathbf{j}$$

- (a) Find an expression for the acceleration of the particle at time t .

(3)

- (b) The mass of the particle is 5 kg.

- (i) Find an expression for the force $\mathbf{F}$ acting on the particle at time t .

(2)

- (ii) Find the magnitude of $\mathbf{F}$ when $t = 0$.

(2)

- (c) Find the value of t when $\mathbf{F}$ acts due west.

(2)

- (d) When $t = 0$, the particle is at the point with position vector $(6\mathbf{i} + 5\mathbf{j}) \text{ m}$.

Find the position vector, $\mathbf{r}$ metres, of the particle at time t .

(5)

(Total 14 marks)

Q32.

A particle moves along a straight line through the origin. At time t , the displacement, s , of the particle from the origin is given by

$$s = 5t^2 + 3 \cos 4t$$

Find the velocity of the particle at time t .

(Total 3 marks)

Q33.

A particle moves under the action of a force, $\mathbf{F}$ newtons. At time t seconds, the velocity, $\mathbf{v} \text{ m s}^{-1}$, of the particle is given by

$$\mathbf{v} = (t^3 - 15t - 5)\mathbf{i} + (6t - t^2)\mathbf{j}$$

- (a) Find an expression for the acceleration of the particle at time t .

(3)

(b) The mass of the particle is 4 kg.

(i) Show that, at time t ,

$$\mathbf{F} = (12t^2 - 60)\mathbf{i} + (24 - 8t)\mathbf{j}$$

(2)

(ii) Find the magnitude of $\mathbf{F}$ when $t = 2$.

(4)

(Total 9 marks)

Q34.

A particle moves in a straight line and at time t it has velocity v , where

$$v = 3t^2 - 2 \sin 3t + 6$$

(a) (i) Find an expression for the acceleration of the particle at time t .

(2)

(ii) When $t = \frac{\pi}{3}$, show that the acceleration of the particle is $2\pi + 6$.

(2)

(b) When $t = 0$, the particle is at the origin.

Find an expression for the displacement of the particle from the origin at time t .

(4)

(Total 8 marks)

Q35.

A particle moves in a horizontal plane under the action of a single force, $\mathbf{F}$ newtons. The unit vectors $\mathbf{i}$ and $\mathbf{j}$ are directed east and north respectively. At time t seconds, the position vector, $\mathbf{r}$ metres, of the particle is given by

$$\mathbf{r} = (t^3 - 3t^2 + 4)\mathbf{i} + (4t + t^2)\mathbf{j}$$

(a) Find an expression for the velocity of the particle at time t .

(2)

(b) The mass of the particle is 3 kg.

(i) Find an expression for $\mathbf{F}$ at time t .

(3)

(ii) Find the magnitude of $\mathbf{F}$ when $t = 3$.

(2)

- (c) Find the value of t when $\mathbf{F}$ acts due north.

(2)

(Total 9 marks)



EXAM PAPERS PRACTICE

©2025 Exam Papers Practice. All rights reserved.